The son of the former chief of staff and present member of the war cabinet, Gadi Eisenkot, has fallen in Gaza today.

For the first time, the Israeli television has shown images of tens, maybe hundreds, of Hamas prisoners. Also, today was the quietest day since October 7 in terms of rockets fired at Israel from the enclave. Does this signal the beginning of the end? I do not believe that this is possible without Deif and certainly Sinwar being caught or killed.

We received an email today from people we have known for some years and whom we considered as friends. The wife, who wrote, expostulates on the horrible carnage perpetrated by the IDF in Gaza. We didn't get a word from her after October 7, nor since, about the Israelis massacred or taken hostage. In situations like this, many so-called friendships are put to the test and shown for what they are.

## *Friday, December 8*

According to well-informed Israeli sources, President Biden wants the IDF to complete its operations by the end of the year. Secretary-General António Gutteres will use Article 99 of the UN Charter in a vote of the Security Council to put an end to the operations in the enclave before the "occurrence of a humanitarian catastrophe." The article has not been used since the Bangladesh war, fifty years ago.

The United States applied its veto, Great Britain abstained, and thirteen countries voted for the resolution. It shows that Israel is now fighting on borrowed time, until December 31.

Al Arabiya, the TV network of the UAE, showed an elderly Palestinian woman shouting that Hamas was stealing the humanitarian aid arriving in the enclave and hoarding it in its tunnels. "Shoot me if you want," she added. Apparently, as the fighting in Khan Yunis goes on, a new set of negotiations is being planned, with Egypt in the main mediating role: